

DTD Education Lane

What Not To Research As Core Content

1. Purpose

This document defines what must not be researched as core Education content for DTD.

DTD Education is not trying to become a generic dog training library. Its purpose is to help new dog owners make better early decisions before trainer matching.

Research must support the Education lane's locked objectives:

- reduce owner confusion
- improve owner judgment
- prevent accidental escalation
- build calm routines
- identify when education is not enough
- prepare owners for trainer support

If a topic does not support those objectives, it should not be researched as core content.

2. Core Exclusion Rule

Do not research a topic as core content if it mainly answers:

"How do I train my dog to do this skill?"

Instead, DTD Education should focus on:

"What is happening, what should the owner avoid, what should they change, what should they do next, and when is trainer or vet support needed?"

3. Excluded Core Research Categories

3.1 Tricks and Entertainment Training

Do not research as core content:

- roll over
- spin
- shake hands
- play dead
- fetch tricks

- cute social media behaviours
- party tricks
- performance tricks
- novelty behaviours

Reason:

These do not support new-owner decision-making before trainer matching.

They may be optional future engagement content, but they are not core DTD Education.

3.2 Generic Obedience Drills

Do not centre core research on:

- sit
- stay
- drop
- heel
- come
- place
- loose-leash walking as a technical drill
- formal recall training
- duration training
- distance training
- obedience sequences

Reason:

These are widely available online and are not DTD's main differentiator.

DTD may reference simple cues only when they support owner judgment, safety, routine-building, or trainer readiness.

Allowed use:

- "sit before food" as a calm routine
- "come" only as a safety or trainer-readiness concept
- "leave it" only when connected to owner decision-making around hazards

Not allowed:

- turning the course into an obedience training programme
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3.3 Advanced Behaviour Modification

Do not research as core self-guided content:

- aggression treatment protocols
- resource guarding treatment plans
- bite rehabilitation
- severe reactivity protocols
- desensitisation plans for serious fear cases
- counter-conditioning protocols for complex cases
- separation anxiety treatment plans
- compulsive behaviour treatment
- trauma rehabilitation
- behaviour modification plans requiring professional supervision

Reason:

These belong with qualified trainers, behaviour professionals, or veterinarians.

DTD Education may help owners recognise escalation points and prepare information for professional support, but it must not provide trainer-level treatment protocols.

Allowed use:

- when to seek help
 - what information to record
 - what not to do while waiting for support
 - how to describe the issue safely
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3.4 Medical Diagnosis or Veterinary Treatment

Do not research as core instructional content:

- diagnosing illness
- treating vomiting, diarrhoea, lethargy, limping, pain, or collapse
- medication advice
- supplement advice
- vaccine schedules as prescriptive medical plans
- parasite treatment instructions
- diet treatment plans
- home remedies
- emergency treatment steps beyond seeking urgent care

Reason:

DTD Education must not act as veterinary advice.

Allowed use:

- health red flags
 - when to call a vet
 - when behaviour may not be a training issue
 - what observations to bring to the vet
 - general first-vet-visit preparation from official sources
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3.5 Breed Encyclopaedia Content

Do not research as core content:

- breed histories
- breed rankings
- breed temperament stereotypes
- “best breeds for families”
- “most aggressive breeds”
- “easiest breeds to train”
- breed-by-breed training guides
- breed-based guarantees
- breed popularity articles

Reason:

This risks becoming generic SEO content and may promote inaccurate assumptions.

Allowed use:

- reminding owners that individual behaviour, environment, health, history, and training context matter
 - encouraging trainer assessment rather than breed assumptions
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3.6 Long Theory Lessons

Do not research as core learner-facing content:

- dense learning theory
- academic behaviour models
- neurobiology-heavy explanations
- long histories of dog domestication
- operant conditioning lectures
- dominance theory debates as long-form content
- technical behaviour terminology for its own sake

Reason:

DTD Education is action-first and mobile-first. Theory should only be included when it directly helps the owner make a better decision.

Allowed use:

- short plain-English explanation attached to an action
 - “why this matters” in one or two simple sentences
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3.7 Generic Puppy Blog Topics

Do not research generic versions of:

- “how to train a puppy”
- “puppy training tips”
- “top 10 puppy mistakes”
- “best puppy toys”
- “how to make your dog happy”
- “how to bond with your puppy”
- “puppy checklist” as a generic shopping list
- “dog training basics”
- “beginner dog training guide”

Reason:

These are already saturated online.

Allowed only if reframed into DTD’s decision-support model:

- what the owner should notice
 - what mistake to avoid
 - what to change first
 - when to escalate
 - what to tell a trainer
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3.8 Product Recommendation Content

Do not research as core content:

- best crates
- best harnesses
- best leashes
- best puppy food brands
- best toys
- best treats
- best cleaners
- best cameras
- best GPS trackers

Reason:

This shifts the Education lane toward affiliate-style content and away from decision support.

Allowed use:

- general product category guidance only when needed for safety or routine
- example: “use an enzymatic cleaner for urine accidents”
- example: “use safe chew items appropriate for the dog’s size”

Avoid brand-led recommendation content unless a separate commercial strategy is intentionally approved.

3.9 Trainer Replacement Content

Do not research content that implies the owner can solve all issues alone.

Avoid:

- “fix aggression yourself”
- “stop biting permanently without a trainer”
- “cure separation anxiety at home”
- “solve reactivity in 7 days”
- “train any dog without professional help”
- “avoid paying for a trainer”

Reason:

DTD Education supports trainer matching. It must not undermine trainer value or create unsafe expectations.

Allowed use:

- “try this first for mild early issues”
- “seek trainer help if the issue repeats, worsens, or feels unsafe”
- “prepare these notes before contacting a trainer”

3.10 SEO Filler Topics

Do not research content only because it may attract traffic.

Avoid:

- shallow listicles
- repetitive advice articles
- keyword-stuffed training pages
- generic seasonal dog content
- broad informational pages with no decision support
- content that does not connect to owner readiness or trainer matching

Reason:

The Education lane must remain useful, trusted, and differentiated.

Every researched topic must serve a user decision.

4. Red-Flag Research Questions

Do not proceed if the research question sounds like:

- "How do I teach my dog to sit?"
- "What are the best tricks to teach a puppy?"
- "What is the best dog breed?"
- "How do I fix aggression myself?"
- "What is the best dog food brand?"
- "How do I train my dog without a trainer?"
- "What are fun dog commands?"
- "How do I stop all barking?"
- "How do I cure separation anxiety?"
- "What are the top puppy training tips?"

These are either generic, unsafe, too broad, or misaligned with DTD Education.

5. Allowed Reframes

Some excluded topics may be used only if reframed correctly.

Generic topic	Do not research as	Approved DTD reframe
Sit	obedience command	calm routine before food, doors, and handling
Recall	formal command training	safety risk and when trainer help is needed
Barking	stop barking guide	what barking may signal and what to change first
Biting	obedience problem	normal puppy mouth behaviour vs unsafe escalation
Crate training	full crate course	safe rest zone and owner routine support
Socialisation	exposure checklist only	safe exposure, fear prevention, and escalation signs
Separation anxiety	cure-at-home plan	early alone-time foundations and when to seek help
Aggression	treatment protocol	safety red flags and trainer-readiness notes
Dog food	brand comparison	what to ask the vet and how treats affect training
Harnesses	product review	safe handling and public management basics

6. Research Approval Test

Before researching any topic, answer these questions.

1. Does this reduce new-owner confusion?

If no, deprioritise.

2. Does this improve owner judgment?

If no, deprioritise.

3. Does this prevent accidental escalation?

If no, deprioritise.

4. Does this build calm routines?

If no, deprioritise.

5. Does this identify when education is not enough?

If no, revise.

6. Does this prepare the owner for trainer support?

If no, revise or exclude.

7. Is this already generic internet content?

If yes, reframe or exclude.

8. Could this become unsafe without professional assessment?

If yes, limit it to recognition, safety, escalation, and trainer-readiness.

7. Hard Exclusion Statement

The following must not be developed as core DTD Education content:

Tricks, generic obedience drills, trainer-level behaviour modification, aggression treatment plans, veterinary diagnosis, medical treatment advice, breed encyclopaedia content, product review content, long theory lessons, generic puppy blog articles, or SEO filler.

These may only appear if they directly support owner decision-making, escalation awareness, or trainer-readiness.

8. Final Rule

If the content can be summarised as:

“Here is how to train your dog to do X,”

it is probably not core DTD Education.

If the content can be summarised as:

“Here is how to understand what is happening, avoid making it worse, take the right next step, and prepare for help if needed,”

it belongs in DTD Education.